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UNITED STATES DEPARTMENT OF THE INTERIOR
NATIONAL PARK SERVICE

NATIONAL REGISTER OF HISTORIC PLACES INVENTORY -- NOMINATION FORM

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From the end of World War I until just prior to World War II, Fort Lawton lapsed into a period of relative unimportance with most of the military activities centering on the National Guard training activities. The Post was offered to the City of Seattle in 1938 for the price of one dollar, but was refused due to the adverse economic situation of the city.

By 1940, Fort Lawton consisted of various administrative and living quarters, plus marksmanship ranges, powder magazines, hospital, cemetery, and a golf course.

1941 was the beginning of the rebirth of Fort Lawton with the designation of the post as a major point of troop debarkation. At the height of World War II, over one million servicemen were processed thru Fort Lawton for the combat zones of the Pacific and the Far East. Additionally, the post was used as a German prisoner of war compound. Once again, Fort Lawton's importance diminished after World War II to a position of relative insignificance. The post was temporarily revived with the activation of the 49th Air Defense Artillery Group in the 1960s. From the period of approximately 1910 thru 1977 various efforts and pressures were brought to return the post to the City of Seattle. During 1971, approximately 391 acres were transferred to the city, forming the nucleus of the present day "Discovery Park".

The historical significance of Fort Lawton rests with its close association with the City of Seattle during its formative and expansion period of the early 1900s. Fort Lawton represented military protection for the Puget Sound region and provided a sense of security to the people of the State of Washington. It has long been accessible to the people of the region as a place to enjoy charming scenery, parade grounds, and the historic buildings of another era.